



M/J Visual Art 3

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADE 8 · FULL YEAR

~4¼ hrs per week · 50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More artworks and projects are approved for this course than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in works studied and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

M/J Visual Art 3 builds on foundational skills as scholars study classical and contemporary works to strengthen observation, design, and craftsmanship, applying the elements and principles of art with increasing intention. The year travels from ancient Greece and Rome through the Renaissance to Van Gogh, Picasso, Pop Art, and Op Art — every stop paired with a hands-on studio project of the scholar's own. Through studio practice and immersive VR-enhanced experiences, scholars create original artworks, reflect critically on their artistic choices, and connect visual art to history, culture, and emerging creative technologies.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

Q1 Foundations and the Ancient World (Units 1–5)

Elements of Art review booklet, a Greek column value drawing, Roman mosaic painting, Day of the Dead sugar skulls, and a dragon's-eye texture study.

Q3 Modern Masters (Units 12–16)

Galaxy paintings (a science crossover), Van Gogh pop-up chairs, Picasso monochromatic painting, and Pop Art from Cerealism collage to Warhol-style relief printing.

Q2 Perspective and Color Theory (Units 7–11)

Renaissance one-point perspective room drawing, silhouette skylines, analogous-color cacti, Tim Burton-inspired value snowmen, and watercolor snow globes.

Q4 Parody, Digital, Clay, and Op Art (Units 17–21)

An American Gothic parody, a half-cartoon digital portrait, clay relief, Bridget Riley optical illusions, and an end-of-year gallery and art show.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Each unit pairs looking and making: scholars study real artworks and movements, then create their own project.
- Units run about two weeks: learn the concept and technique, then produce, refine, and submit the finished piece.
- Discussion connects every project to the Elements of Art and Principles of Design.
- VR-enhanced experiences and galleries woven through the year on Optima's VR campus.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes / week

≈ 50 minutes a day, Monday–Friday

- Studio time and technique lessons fill most of the scheduled minutes.
- Project-finish weeks and the end-of-year art show may run longer.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- Art supplies by unit: drawing pencils, paper, paint and watercolor, and clay for the relief unit (as assigned).
- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas, plus a way to photograph finished work for submission.
- Access to Optima's VR campus for galleries and VR-enhanced experiences.

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting daily on the middle-school schedule.